

# AI FOR GLOBAL TRADE

**For UN Global Hackathon: Responsive AI & Regulatory Intelligence**

*Responsible AI for a better world for all*



## THE STAKES

# AI could reshape trade — but only if the Global the room the room

**+34–37%**

potential lift to world trade by 2040  
(WTO, 2025)

**+14–15%**

income gain for low- & middle-  
income economies if they close half  
the digital gap

**87%**

of notable AI models sit in high-  
income economies — home to 17%  
of people

**The bottom line:** On current trends, AI compounds the development divide. The window to change course: **2025–2027.**



# The trade challenges AI addresses most effectively

AI delivers most where transaction costs are highest, data is digitised and decisions repeat — exactly the chokepoints squeezing developing-economy traders (trade costs ≈ 219% ad valorem in developing vs 134% in high-income economies).



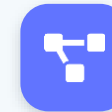
## Trade finance gap

US\$2.5tn unmet (ADB 2026) — ~10% of merchandise trade. 84% of banks now use AI for risk; alt-data scoring makes thin-file SMEs bankable.



## Customs & documentation

20–40 docs per shipment. Paperless trade could add US\$36–257bn in Asia-Pacific exports/yr. AI automates HS coding & risk targeting.



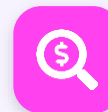
## Supply-chain visibility

Firms lose ~45% of a year's EBITDA per decade to disruption. Resilience leaders cut losses 50% and recover 40% faster.



## Non-tariff measures

NTMs now cost more than tariffs for 88% of countries. LDCs lose ~10% of G20-bound exports; AI can cut compliance costs ~19%.



## Illicit trade & laundering

Trade-based money laundering ≈ US\$0.8–2tn/yr. Under 5% of shipments are screened — anomaly detection is the only response at scale.

## Tested solutions — evidence, not hype



### AI customs risk targeting

**MOST EVIDENCE-RICH**

Brazil SISAM screens 100% of declarations; ~30% of inspections AI-driven. Korea saves ~US\$95m/yr. WCO BACUDA gives free open-source tools.



### Automated HS classification

**MATURE**

Leading tools ~85–89% accurate at 10-digit level. StanChart's IBM engine processes 36m pages/yr across 30+ markets incl. Africa & South Asia.



### SME alternative-data credit

**BIGGEST SUCCESS**

Ant MYbank's "310" model: 3-min apply, 1-sec approve. 53m SMEs served at ~1.5% NPL. The most replicable model for closing the gap.



### Smart ports

**SCALES MID-INCOME**

Qingdao runs ~2x a manned terminal; PSA Tuas handled 40.9m TEU in 2024. CAPEX-heavy but partial automation alone adds ~12.7% throughput.



### Public digital trade backbones

**OUTPERFORMING**

Singapore NTP saves ~US\$450m/yr; India ULIP hit 1.6bn API calls; ASEAN Single Window saved >US\$6.4bn. Outperform private platforms.



### No-regret first move

Deploy WCO BACUDA-style customs AI: open-source, low-CAPEX, politically uncontroversial.

### 03 · PROMINENT EXAMPLES

## What global companies have deployed

The pattern: long-horizon, narrow-purpose AI wins; grand platform plays fail without neutral governance.



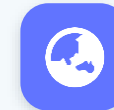
#### Maersk

Captain Peter tracks 380k reefer containers; NavAssist cuts fuel up to 12%. But TradeLens collapsed in 2023 — competitors distrusted a Maersk-run "neutral" platform.



#### UPS · ORION

The longest-running ROI-positive AI in trade logistics — a decade of refinement saves 100m miles and US\$300–400m every year.



#### Alibaba · Cainiao

Tracks 224 countries at 98% on-time. eWTP hubs lifted Rwandan exports 124% in 2019. The most consequential Global South export.



#### JD.com

1,000+ AI logistics use cases, 600+ autonomous vehicles in 30 cities; piloting drone delivery in West Java — relevant to archipelagic economies.



#### PSA & DP World

PSA Singapore moved 100.2m TEU in 2024; DP World's CARGOES spans 78 countries with predictive analytics & an AI customs engine.



#### Microsoft · StanChart

Post-TradeLens pivot: agentic AI on ICC digital standards. Amazon committed US\$33bn+ to SE Asia cloud/AI through 2039.

# AI can compound the divide it could close

UNCTAD warns the US\$4.8tn AI market (2033) will "deepen inequalities" without deliberate policy. Six risks matter most for trade negotiators.



## Connectivity divide

Internet reaches 93% in high-income vs 27% in low-income economies; digitally-deliverable services = 60%+ of advanced exports but only 15% in LDCs.



## Data & platform power

US + China hold half the world's data centres, 94% of AI start-up funding. Three clouds run ~62% of the market.



## Algorithmic bias

A 10-algorithm African fintech audit found a 37% underfunding penalty against women-led SMEs at identical financials.



## Job displacement

88% of Cambodian & 86% of Vietnamese garment jobs are automatable — ~137m ASEAN workers, disproportionately women.



## Cyber exposure

Maersk's NotPetya hit cost US\$250–300m. The 2023 LockBit attack shut Japan's Port of Nagoya for three days.



## Energy & rules

Data-centre power demand ~doubles to 945 TWh by 2030. EU AI Act's extraterritorial reach becomes a market-access condition.

# The 2025–2027 window will shape AI 2030

Only 7 of 193 UN member states sit in all major AI-governance initiatives — 118, mostly Global South, are absent. The architecture is being built now.

## Frameworks & vehicles to engage



### Global Digital Compact (2024)

Created an International Scientific Panel, AI Standards Exchange, Capacity-Building Network & Global Fund for AI.



### UNESCO Ethics Recommendation

Adopted by 194 states — the only near-universal AI ethics instrument, with operational readiness tools.



### OECD AI Principles · 47 jurisdictions

The de facto interoperability anchor, imported into the EU AI Act and UN texts.



### Regional rules moving faster

AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol (54 states); ASEAN DEFA → up to US\$2tn by 2030; DEPA accession queue.

## 2030 — by the numbers

**US\$15.7tn**

added to global economy by 2030 (PwC)

**~US\$1tn**

SE Asia AI dividend by 2030 (13–18% of GDP)

**20→2 min**

customs document checks, AI-enabled (ADB-ESCAP)

**2025–27**

the window to shape the rules — at MC14 & beyond

# Five priorities for trade negotiators

1

## Invest in all four Cs

Connectivity, Compute, Context & Competency — via the ADB Digital Highway and bilateral compute-sharing.

2

## Defend policy space

Anchor rules on UNESCO & OECD definitions, not EU conformity assessments; resist source-code lock-ins.

3

## Lock in flexibilities

Five-year LDC transitions, an AI Aid-for-Trade window, tech-transfer clauses, industrial-policy carve-outs.

4

## Operationalise responsible AI

Deploy WCO BACUDA tools now; mandate human-in-the-loop oversight and bias audits in customs & credit.

5

## Be rule-makers, not takers

Coordinate G77 & African Group; claim seats in the OECD AI WP and Global Dialogue on AI Governance.

*The evidence, the tools and the institutional vehicles already exist. What's needed is coordinated political will.*



# Responsible AI for a better world for all

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit global initiative — 6,000+ members across 60 countries — harnessing AI to benefit humanity while minimising harm. Focus: Responsible AI, AI for All, AI for Good.



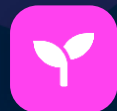
## Advancing human potential

Equal access to AI education; developing leaders who champion Responsible AI for all.



## Scale open AI infrastructure

Open data, open models, open tools & distributed computing to scale trustworthy AI globally.



## Solving planetary challenges

AI accessibility & disability inclusion, economic mobility, environmental sustainability.

### AI 2030 — by the numbers

**100+**

global convenings & summits

**50,000+**

event attendees worldwide

**150+**

certified Responsible AI leaders

**120+**

startups accelerated & supported

**5,000+**

open-source tools in the RAI marketplace

**8**

industry & government working groups

# THANK YOU

Whether AI 2030 closes the development divide or compounds it will be decided by the negotiators in this room — over the next 24 months.



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